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Critical Thinking: A Skill for Life

We are surrounded by information. News, ads, social media, and opinions reach us every day. But not everything we see or hear is true or useful. Critical thinking is the ability to question, analyze, and evaluate information before accepting it. It helps us make better decisions, avoid being misled, and form our own well-reasoned views. [1] Critical thinking is not about doubting everything; it is about asking the right questions and using evidence and logic to reach sound conclusions.

One key part of critical thinking is recognizing bias. Everyone has beliefs and experiences that shape how they see the world. Advertisers want to sell products; some news sources have political leanings. When we understand that information can be slanted, we can look for multiple sources and different viewpoints before forming an opinion. [2] Learning to identify bias helps us separate facts from opinions, and opinions from deliberate attempts to mislead, so we can make more informed choices.

Another important skill is evaluating evidence. Is a claim supported by data, studies, or expert opinion? Or is it based on a single story, a rumor, or an emotional appeal? Strong arguments rely on evidence that can be checked and verified. [3] Good critical thinkers look for reliable sources, ask "how do we know?" and are willing to change their minds when new evidence appears.

Critical thinking also means being aware of our own assumptions. We all have blind spots—ideas we take for granted without questioning. Reflecting on why we believe what we believe can help us discover weaknesses in our own reasoning and become more open to other perspectives. [4] Self-awareness is an essential part of critical thinking, as it allows us to improve our reasoning and engage more fairly with ideas that differ from our own.

Schools are increasingly teaching critical thinking through debate, problem-solving, and projects that require research and analysis. But the skill is valuable far beyond the classroom. [5] In work, relationships, and daily life, critical thinking helps us navigate a complex world, resist manipulation, and contribute to thoughtful, constructive discussions that move society forward.

选项

A. Critical thinking is not about doubting everything; it is about asking the right questions and using evidence and logic to reach sound conclusions. B. Learning to identify bias helps us separate facts from opinions, and opinions from deliberate attempts to mislead, so we can make more informed choices. C. Good critical thinkers look for reliable

sources, ask "how do we know?" and are willing to change their minds when new evidence appears. D. Self-awareness is an essential part of critical thinking, as it allows us to improve our reasoning and engage more fairly with ideas that differ from our own. E. In work, relationships, and daily life, critical thinking helps us navigate a complex world, resist manipulation, and contribute to thoughtful, constructive discussions that move society forward. F. For example, when a friend shares a shocking story they saw online, a critical thinker might ask where it came from and whether other sources confirm it before passing it on.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前说信息泛滥、非全真实有用，引出批判性思维——质疑、分析、评估，空后需澄清批判性思维的本质。A的"not about doubting everything"纠正常见误解，"asking the right questions and using evidence and logic to reach sound conclusions"与"question, analyze, and evaluate"对应，定义批判性思维。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：空前说识别偏见——每人有信念与经历、广告与媒体有立场、应寻求多源与多视角，空后需总结识别偏见的好处。B的"Learning to identify bias helps us separate facts from opinions, and opinions from deliberate attempts to mislead"与前文"information can be slanted"呼应，"make more informed choices"与"look for multiple sources"逻辑一致。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：空前说评估证据——主张是否有数据、研究、专家支持，还是基于个案、谣言或情绪，强论证需可核实证据，空后需总结优秀批判思考者的行为。C的"Good critical thinkers look for reliable sources, ask 'how do we know?'"与"evaluating evidence"对应，"willing to change their minds when new evidence appears"与"evidence that can be checked"衔接。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：空前说意识到自身假设——盲点、未经质疑的想法、反思信念可发现推理弱点、更包容异见，空后需强调自我觉察的地位。D的"Self-awareness is an essential part of critical thinking"承接前文自我反思，"improve our reasoning and engage more fairly with ideas that differ"与"discover weaknesses... become more open"呼应。

- [5] E：
    - **线索**：空前说学校通过辩论、问题解决、研究项目教授批判性思维，但该技能超越课堂，空后需总结批判性思维在生活中的广泛价值。E的"In work, relationships, and daily life"与"far beyond the classroom"对应，"navigate a complex world, resist manipulation, and contribute to... discussions"是全文收尾的合理升华。
- **干扰项分析**：
    - **F. For example, when a friend shares a shocking story they saw online, a critical thinker might ask where it came from and whether other sources confirm it before passing it on.**：以For example开头，为具体情境举例（朋友分享网传故事）。各空均为概括或过渡句；[2]或[3]易被误选，但两空分别需"识别偏见的好处"与"评估证据的行为"概括，不需要具体场景案例。